

Samia Sharmin

Architect | Writer | Content & Brand Strategist | Heritage Researcher | Educator

Dhaka, Bangladesh | bivasamia@gmail.com | Available for remote collaboration

PROFILE

Architect, writer, content strategist, educator, and heritage researcher with experience across building-material brand strategy, architecture-focused editorial work, publication coordination, research documentation, exhibition and gallery support, youth and event coordination, and design communication. Skilled in translating architectural, material, cultural, and institutional knowledge into clear public-facing content for specialist and general audiences. Experienced in editorial workflows, interviews, visual coordination, campaign brief development, academic teaching, archival documentation, heritage programming, large-scale event facilitation, and cross-functional stakeholder coordination.

CORE EXPERTISE

Writing & Editorial	Architecture writing, feature writing, interview-based storytelling, editorial planning, copywriting, caption writing, layout review, publication workflow, public communication.
Brand & Content	Building-material communication, brand proposition, target-audience profiling, product messaging, campaign concepts, creative briefing, agency coordination, brand alignment.
Research & Heritage	Urban heritage research, architectural history, community-based and participatory methods, archival inquiry, collection-based research, exhibition documentation, cultural narratives.
Teaching & Programs	Course delivery, student mentorship, student portfolio archives, workshop coordination, youth engagement, event planning, team supervision, facilitation, public speaking.
Architecture & Design	Architectural documentation, project analysis, museum and gallery environments, exhibition content, building materials, sustainable urban design and participatory planning.

EDUCATION & GRADUATE ADMISSION

Master of Science in Community and Regional Planning (MSCRP) | The University of Texas at Austin | Austin, TX

Admitted; deferred & expected enrollment in Fall 2027

- Planning-focused graduate admission noted in architecture-content and archive/heritage versions of the CV.

Master of Urban Planning (MUP) | Texas A&M University | College Station, TX

Admitted; deferred & expected enrollment in Fall 2027

- Program admission used in a graduate assistantship resume focused on operations, events, and student-facing leadership

Bachelor of Architecture (B.Arch.) | University of Asia Pacific | Dhaka, Bangladesh

2017 - 2022

- CGPA: 3.21/4.00.
- Dean's Merit Award, 4th Year, 1st Semester; merit-based scholarship, 2nd Year, 1st Semester; 100% scholarship in 1st semester based on SSC and HSC results.

Higher Secondary Certificate (Science) | Holy Cross College | Dhaka, Bangladesh

2016

- GPA: 5.00.

Secondary School Certificate (Science) | Tejgaon Government Girls' High School | Dhaka, Bangladesh

2014

- GPA: 5.00.

PROFESSIONAL, EDITORIAL & BRAND EXPERIENCE

Content & Brand Strategist / Brand Strategist (Full-time) | Abul Khair Group | Dhaka, Bangladesh

Nov 2024 - Present

- Develop concepts, copy, communication directions, brand propositions, target-audience profiles, messaging frameworks, and campaign materials for building-material brands.
- Translate product value into clear content for architecture, construction, and consumer audiences while aligning messaging with brand and business goals.
- Coordinate between brand managers, internal teams, creative agencies, production partners, and external collaborators; convert business goals into clear briefs and actionable creative direction.

- Support cross-functional communication to keep content development, campaign planning, documentation, and publication-oriented materials organized and on schedule.
- Contribute to architect-industry collaborations, architecture-student competitions, youth programs, reality/talent-based productions, and knowledge-sharing initiatives connected to building materials, heritage, craft, and emerging architects.

Editorial Team / Editorial Associate (Part-time) | ArchBiz Magazine | Dhaka, Bangladesh

2025 - Present

- Manage architecture and design-related editorial content from topic selection to print preparation.
- Identify relevant stories, projects, designers, industry themes, and built-environment topics for publication.
- Communicate with interviewees, architects, designers, contributors, and project representatives to clarify story direction and content requirements.
- Write research-informed articles and interview-based content for architecture, art, and business audiences.
- Coordinate project images, drawings, captions, references, and visual assets; review layouts before print for content accuracy, visual alignment, caption quality, and presentation consistency.

Content Writer / Contributing Writer (Part-time) | Ceramic Bangladesh Magazine / BCMEA | Dhaka, Bangladesh

2023 - Present

- Develop articles and features on ceramics, building materials, architecture, design, and industry trends.
- Write research-informed content connecting material innovation, design application, architects, engineers, and industry communication.
- Conduct interviews with architects, engineers, and industry leaders; coordinate visuals, captions, references, and supporting content details for publication-ready editorial output.

Contributing Feature & Content Writer; Event Organizer & Youth Program Facilitator (Part-time) | The Daily Prothom Alo / Kishor Alo | Dhaka, Bangladesh

2012 - Present; youth/event programs from 2014 - Present

- Write feature articles, interviews, and accessible design-focused stories on architecture, design, culture, award-winning projects, and built-environment topics for a broad public readership.
- Identify architecture, interior design, cultural, youth, and public-interest stories suitable for mainstream publication.
- Coordinate and host large-scale national youth events, facilitate youth-centered programs, manage live schedules, speakers, performance transitions, volunteers, and event-day logistics.
- Serve as host, facilitator, and public speaker for programs emphasizing safe participation, positive conduct, community wellbeing, and youth engagement.

ACADEMIC, RESEARCH & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lecturer & Research Assistant (Full-time) | Department of Architecture, State University of Bangladesh | Dhaka, Bangladesh

Oct 2022 - Oct 2024

- Conducted research on urban heritage and architectural history using community-based and participatory methodologies; produced documentation, analysis, and publication-ready research outputs.
- Developed and delivered courses in design, Urban Design Theory, Bengal History, Architecture Conservation, Technical Writing and Verbal Communication, Cost Estimation, and Working Detail I.
- Instructed and mentored 30-40 undergraduate students per course, providing academic guidance, structured oversight, feedback, and student wellbeing-centered support.
- Coordinated course logistics including schedules, assessments, student activities, reporting, and academic administration across multiple classes within fixed timelines.
- Supported archival organization and management of academic materials, including student portfolio archives; served on committees for communications, website content, public relations, social media, and portfolio documentation.
- Organized outreach initiatives contributing to architectural library collections and student-facing academic resources.

Research Associate / Heritage Research Contributor (Part-time) | Finding Bangladesh: Heritage Research & Youth Engagement Platform; supported by British Council | Bangladesh

Various engagements listed across CVs: 2018 - 2022 and Oct 2023 - Present

- Conduct research on historic urban settlements, monuments, ancient histories, folklores, mythologies, and cultural narratives across Bangladesh.
- Joined / continued with the platform after winning the Find Your Bangladesh Competition with a short documentary film, research paper, and presentation.
- Produce cultural storytelling projects, documentary film outputs, heritage documentation, and research resources that contribute to heritage archives and public interpretation.
- Interpret and disseminate cultural knowledge for academic, community, youth, and public audiences.

ARCHITECTURE, EXHIBITION, MUSEUM & HERITAGE PROGRAMS

Junior Architect / Architect (Full-time) | SYSTEM Architects | Dhaka, Bangladesh

Jul 2022 - Sep 2022

- Contributed to architectural design, project documentation, publications, client communication, and presentation preparation.
- Supported cultural and museum-related projects, including the Bangladesh National Museum.
- Assisted in the development of the Shilpacharya Zainul Abedin Gallery, engaging with exhibition environments, gallery experience, and visitor-oriented design.

Exhibition & Gallery Organizer | National Museum / Artist Gallery | Bangladesh

Various projects, 2021 - Present

- Supported exhibition planning, coordination, installation, research, documentation, curatorial development, and visitor engagement in museum and gallery contexts.
- Contributed to heritage, art, and architecture exhibitions with attention to interpretation, presentation, and public-facing experience.

Program Organizer | UNESCO World Heritage Volunteers Program / Perceive | Bangladesh

2023

- Organized and coordinated a 10-day international heritage workshop supported by UNESCO, the Department of Archaeology Bangladesh, and the Bangladesh National Museum.
- Managed lectures, archival exploration, museum gallery engagement, site visits, hands-on training activities, and multi-site program logistics.
- Facilitated collaboration among international participants, heritage professionals, cultural institutions, and academic institutions.

EVENT LEADERSHIP, CREATIVE PRACTICE & YOUTH ENGAGEMENT

Dance Trainer, Choreographer & Event Coordinator | Independent / Institutional Engagements

Multiple years

- Led and trained performance teams ranging from 15 to 150 participants, coordinating schedules, enforcing conduct standards, and ensuring readiness for live events.
- Planned and executed cultural, institutional, and public programs requiring detailed coordination, real-time operational oversight, backstage supervision, and participant accountability.
- Managed time-sensitive challenges during live events while maintaining morale, discipline, participant safety, inclusion, and collaboration.

Enlisted Performing Artist | Bangladesh Television and Bangladesh Shilpakala Academy | Bangladesh

2010 - 2016

- Selected as a national-level enlisted performing artist based on professional merit.
- Performed within large production teams under strict schedules and live-broadcast conditions; collaborated with directors, producers, and technical teams.

Event Coordinator & Recreational Program Leader | Independent / Institutional Programs | Bangladesh, Nepal, India

Multiple years

- Led hiking and recreational programs across Bangladesh, Nepal, and India, coordinating participants, logistics, itineraries, safety awareness, and on-site operations.
- Conducted heritage study tours across Bangladesh for up to 100 students in historic cities, managing travel logistics, site schedules, group accountability, and supervision.

Leadership & Creative Roles

- President, University Drama Club and Literary Club - directed stage productions, organized large-scale festivals and literary programs, and led creative student activities.
- Pioneer Member, University Cultural Club - co-founded and helped organize campus-wide cultural events.
- Host & Facilitator, Kishor Alo Youth Magazine - hosted youth festivals and large-scale events for one of Bangladesh's prominent youth platforms.
- Theatre Artist & Set Design Contributor - supported theatrical production planning, stage design, and creative direction.
- Voice-over Artist - provided narration and voice-over for national television channels and media productions.
- Film Making - directed short documentary and narrative films on heritage, cultural, urban, and social themes.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Architectural history and heritage of Bengal.
- Sustainable urban design and participatory planning.

- Community-based architecture, urban heritage, cultural narratives, and public-facing interpretation.
- Archival research, exhibition-based work, material innovation, design communication, and architecture journalism.

WORKSHOPS & COLLABORATIVE RESEARCH

Participant, The Making of Publicness Workshop | Bengal Institute; conducted by Arfar Razi | Dhaka

2025

- Investigated two sites in Dhaka through spatial, political, and physical analysis.
- Conducted user-based assessments on comfort, perception, inclusivity, vitality, and likability; produced a video documentary presenting findings and narratives.
- Workshop inspired by a course developed by Bjorn Sletto and conducted by a UT Austin MCRP graduate.

Participant, Participatory Design Workshop | Dhaka Urban Lab, World Bank and DSCC | Dhaka

2021

- Engaged in a neighborhood upgrading project focused on community-based urban interventions and participatory design processes.

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

1. Sharmin, S. (2024). Ancient Cities of Riverine Bengal: In Search for “the Soul” of the Settlements. Rajshahi University Journal of Arts & Law, ISSN 2309-0898. [Published]
2. Sharmin, S. (2024). Three Religious Marvels of Bengal: Comparative Insights into Hindu, Buddhist, and Islamic Architecture. [Accepted, Awaiting Publication]
3. Sharmin, S. (2025). Analyzing Mahallah Fabric in the Sultanate Capital of Gaur: A Review of Findings. [Under Review]

SELECTED AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS & RECOGNITION

- Champion, Find Your Bangladesh Competition - British Council and Finding Bangladesh, 2021; awarded for researching and documenting a heritage site, including myth, legacy, present condition, business model, and preservation strategies.
- Best Volunteer Award, University of Asia Pacific, 2022 - honored for leadership, service contribution, and outstanding contributions to cultural and student activities.
- Dean’s Meritorious List / Dean’s Merit Award, University of Asia Pacific, 2020 / 4th Year, 1st Semester - academic recognition for excellence in architecture coursework.
- Merit-based scholarship, University of Asia Pacific, 2nd Year, 1st Semester; 100% scholarship, 1st semester based on SSC and HSC results.
- 1st Runner-up, Open Mic Speech Competition - Manusher Jonno Foundation, 2019; awarded as a Harmony Ambassador for a speech on religion, peace, and countering radicalism.
- Champion, Talent Hunt Competition, UAP Cultural Club, 2018 and 2019 - performance in cultural and creative categories.
- Marks Allrounder Top 10, National Reality Show, 2010 - selected among top performers in acting, dance, and recitation.
- Champion, Photography Contest - Bengal Institute, 2016; Champion, Photography Contest - Wedding Diary Bangladesh and Kishor Alo, 2014.
- Champion, School Chess Tournament, 2012; National Child Award, District Level, 2008.

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS & PRESENTATIONS

- Conductor, Round Table on Creating Safe Online for Girls and Women, Prothom Alo, 2021.
- Speaker, Forum Next Gen - Sthapatyacharya Muzharul Islam, Muzharul Islam Foundation, 2020.
- Speaker, The Future of Women Architects and Engineers: Challenges and Prospects, Prothom Alo, 2019.

SKILLS

Content & Editorial	Architecture writing, feature writing, editorial planning, interview coordination, copywriting, content development, visual coordination, caption writing, layout review, publication workflow.
Brand & Product	Building-material communication, brand proposition, target-audience profiling, product messaging, campaign concept development, creative briefing, brand alignment, architect-industry collaboration.
Research & Archive	Urban heritage research, architectural history, community-based methods, participatory research, archival documentation, collection-based research, metadata-informed interpretation, exhibition support.
Leadership & Ops	Team supervision and mentoring, staff training and facilitation, event planning and coordination, scheduling, workflow coordination, logistics, conflict resolution, professional communication.
Design & Modeling Graphics & Media	AutoCAD, SketchUp, Rhinoceros 3D, Lumion, ArcGIS, architectural documentation, project analysis. Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere Pro, Adobe Firefly, documentary and visual storytelling.
Administrative	Google Docs, Google Sheets, Google Drive, Gmail, Microsoft Office, documentation and reporting, internal coordination systems, EMS software exposure.

LANGUAGES

- Bengali: Native.
- English: Professional working proficiency / fluent; IELTS Academic Overall 7.5.

REFERENCES

Dr. Abu Sayeed Mostaque Ahmed | Dean, School of Environmental Sciences & Design, University of Asia Pacific

- Email: sayeed@uap-bd.edu

Dr. Sajid Bin Doza | Head, Department of Architecture, State University of Bangladesh

- Email: sajid@sub.edu.bd